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Don't Be Afraid

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Free media and discipleship resources for pastors, leaders, and growing disciples.

Don't Be Afraid

Today's Reading: John 6:16-21

Hearing God's Voice for Today:

"When they had rowed about three or four miles, they saw Jesus walking on the sea and coming near the boat, and they were frightened. But he said to them, 'It is I; do not be afraid.'"

* * * * *

The disciples were crossing the Sea of Galilee. It was approximately six miles to the other side. Jesus was not with them. He watched them from the mountain where he was resting and praying.

The wind blew furiously against them. The sea was rough, yo-yoing their boat up and down, the waves loudly slapping the sides of the boat. They were alone and scared.

They failed to realize this fact: Jesus knew the storm was approaching. He knew what they were going to face before they left the shore. None of this took him by surprise.

As they struggled against the contrary waves, their fear increased. They quickly forgot his miracle with the five loaves and two fish. How quickly people can lose their heart of faith when a storm arises!

As you struggle today against life's wicked winds, blowing contrary to your desires, always remember the facts of this story. Jesus was not surprised by the storm. He took the initiative and came to the disciples. He knew of their struggle. He understood their fears before they felt them.

Jesus is not aloof from your life's storms. He is always moving toward you, knowing what you need from him.

And what does Jesus say to all his fear-filled followers? "It is I; don't be afraid." Fear is the antithesis of faith. Fear destroys faith. Don't be afraid!

And what is the best antidote for fear? It is Jesus' presence. He comes to you, to be with you, in all life's trials and circumstances. He is with you. He upholds you. He strengthens you.

There is nothing, absolutely nothing, that you and Jesus can't face and handle together. His promised presence is what conquers all fear.

Don't be afraid! Take courage. The Lord is with you. Though you may be walking through a dark valley, he is beside you. His spiritual weaponry is available to protect and comfort you. Fasten around yourself his belt of truth. Put on his helmet of salvation. Place his shoes of peace on your feet. Hold high his strong shield of faith to extinguish the fiery darts of the enemy. Know and quote his Word—which is your best offensive weapon against the enemy—along with continuing to pray without ceasing.

Jesus did not give you a spirit of fear, but of love, peace, and a sound mind.

Don't be troubled or afraid. Speak to fear and say, "The Lord is my helper. I will have no fear."

Let Jesus answer the next time fear knocks on the door of your heart. When you do, you'll find fear to be gone.

[from *"Hearing the Voice of God"* by Pastor David Chadwick, *Moments of Hope Church, Charlotte, NC*]